

Assessments

PS50008A Research Methods | Term 2 Spring 2026

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27 May 2026

Assessment Overview

Assessment	Weight	Deadline	Week
Research Plan	20%	Fri 27 Feb 2026, 12 noon	16
MCQ Exam	20%	Wed 11 Mar 2026, in lecture slot	18
EDS Assignment	20%	Fri 20 Mar 2026, 12 noon	19
Research Report	40%	1 May 2026, 12 noon	Post-term

Full details of all assessments are in the Assessment Handbook.

Practice Materials & Examples

💡 Examples of all assessments will be provided

Examples of all assessments will be provided with plenty of support. We cannot give marks for these, but we will work through examples in class.

Research Plan

- Research Plan — Worked Example (PDF)
- Research Plan — Submission Example (PDF)
- Research Plan — Submission Example (Word)

MCQ Exam

- Practice MCQ Test (PDF)
- Practice MCQ Test with Answers (PDF)

EDS Assignment

- EDS Practice Paper 2026 (PDF)

Research Report

- Research Reports in APA Format — Guide (PDF)
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Group Project

The group project is **not separately assessed** but feeds into two assessments:

- **Research Plan** (due Week 16): Based on a choice of research ideas - you provide a research plan.
- **Research Report** (due 1 May, post-term): Individual write-up of group project data

See the Assessment Handbook for full briefs and marking criteria.

Project Timeline

Week	Milestone
11	Form groups (3-4 students)
12-15	Develop research question and design
—	<i>Reading Week</i> — Work on Research Plan
16	Research Plan due Friday 27 Feb; Begin data collection
17-18	Data collection and initial analysis
19-20	Complete analysis; Develop write-up (term ends Week 20)
Easter	Individual report writing
Post-term	Research Report due 1 May

! Individual Responsibility

While data comes from your group project, the Research Report is an **individual** assessment. Each group member writes their own report independently.

Academic Integrity

All assessments must be your own work:

- **Research Plan:** Individual submission
- **MCQ Exam:** Closed-book, no collaboration
- **EDS Assignment:** Individual, no collaboration on calculations
- **Research Report:** Individual write-up (even though data comes from group)

! AI Policy

Using AI tools to generate your work is not permitted. You may use AI to help understand concepts, but submitted work must be your own.

Support

- **Lectures:** Core concepts and worked examples
- **Labs:** Hands-on practice
- **Office hours:** Individual or small group questions
- **VLE:** Assessment briefs, practice materials, discussion forum